Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/andrea-r-518b885 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Acquisition Professional
Analytical Approach
Innovative Thinking

Languages

German
Spanish

Andrea R.

Director of Capture, Auterion | Acquisition Ninja for Deep Tech, Defense & Disruption
Haymarket, Virginia, United States

Summary

I translate breakthrough ideas into funded government programs.

With 25+ years navigating the trenches of defense acquisition, I've led $5B+ in contracts across the Department of Defense, Intelligence Community, and national security innovation hubs. I specialize in helping companies, especially non-traditionals and dual-use tech pioneers, get across the finish line with smart, agile acquisition strategies that cut through red tape and unlock real results.

I've served inside the belly of the beast: Joint Staff, State Department, DIA, NRO, DIU and now I operate from the outside, helping emerging tech companies get through the valley of death, win funding, build momentum, and deliver on mission-critical needs. Whether it's crafting the perfect OTA, navigating SBIR, securing DPA Title III funding, or landing a meeting with the right program office, I know how to make the system work.

Core Specialties
• Acquisition Strategy | OTA, SBIR/STTR, CRADA, DPA
• Defense Business Development | DoD, IC, DHS, NASA, State Department
• Legislative & Executive Branch Engagement
• Space, SDA, AI/ML, Advanced Materials, Industrial Base

If you're building something powerful and need help getting the government to move faster, smarter, and in your direction let's talk.

Experience

Auterion
Director of Capture

August 2025 - Present (11 months)

Innova Defense Solutions
Founder/CEO
October 2017 - Present (8 years 9 months)

AstroForge
Head of Government Relations
March 2025 - June 2025 (4 months)

National Reconnaissance Office (NRO)
Senior Acquisition Specialist & Technical Exchange/Outreach
August 2024 - February 2025 (7 months)

Defense Innovation Unit (DIU)
Agreements Specialist
June 2023 - July 2024 (1 year 2 months)

Defense Intelligence Agency
Senior Contract Specialist
July 2018 - June 2023 (5 years)

National Reconnaissance Office (NRO)
Senior Contract Specialist
October 2017 - July 2018 (10 months)

Defense Intelligence Agency
Senior Contract Specialist
May 2016 - October 2017 (1 year 6 months)

Defense Threat Reduction Agency
Senior Contract Specialist
October 2015 - May 2016 (8 months)

U.S. Department of State
Senior Contract Specialist
September 2014 - October 2015 (1 year 2 months)

U.S. Department of Homeland Security
Senior Contract Specialist
September 2012 - September 2014 (2 years 1 month)

Naval Sea Systems Command (NAVSEA)
Senior Contract Specialist
January 2012 - September 2012 (9 months)

The Joint Staff
Senior Contract Specialist
January 2009 - January 2012 (3 years 1 month)

JORGE SCIENTIFIC CORPORATION
Contract Specialist
January 2008 - January 2009 (1 year 1 month)
Arlington, VA

Defense Information Systems Agency
Analyst
January 2007 - January 2008 (1 year 1 month)

United States Air Force
Program Analyst
June 2005 - January 2007 (1 year 8 months)
Arlington, VA